

When compared by sex, it is observed that in both the urban and rural sectors, the number of males temporarily residing abroad exceeds that of females. However, in the estate rural sector, across all age categories, there is a notably higher prevalence of females temporarily residing abroad compared to males.

According to Table 5.2.3, the primary reason for temporary migration is employment. Accordingly, 86.0 percent (577,919) of the total population who migrated temporarily for employment purposes, while 8.0 percent (53,621) migrated for education. Additionally, 5.7 percent (38,218) migrated for reasons such as a family member's education, employment, or lookafter. A very small percentage, specifically 0.3 percent (2,491), migrated temporarily for other reasons.

Table 5.2.3 : Population Temporarily Living Abroad by District and Main Reason for Living in Abroad, 2024

District	Total		Main reason for living in abroad							
			Employment		Education		Accompanied a family member's need		Other	
	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%	Number	%
Total	672,249	100.0	577,919	86.0	53,621	8.0	38,218	5.7	2,491	0.3
Colombo	71,439	100.0	51,449	72.0	12,339	17.3	7,230	10.1	421	0.6
Gampaha	86,077	100.0	67,844	78.8	10,894	12.7	7,028	8.1	311	0.4
Kalutara	41,352	100.0	34,819	84.2	3,953	9.6	2,469	6.0	111	0.2
Kandy	57,230	100.0	48,904	85.5	4,242	7.4	3,891	6.8	193	0.3
Matale	20,064	100.0	18,526	92.3	755	3.8	730	3.6	53	0.3
Nuwara-Eliya	16,913	100.0	15,895	94.0	402	2.4	572	3.4	44	0.2
Galle	40,344	100.0	35,722	88.5	2,954	7.3	1,555	3.9	113	0.3
Matara	21,320	100.0	18,282	85.8	2,145	10.1	840	3.9	53	0.2
Hambantota	14,231	100.0	12,606	88.6	1,184	8.3	408	2.9	33	0.2
Jaffna	9,425	100.0	7,653	81.2	877	9.3	589	6.2	306	3.3
Mannar	1,640	100.0	1,506	91.8	78	4.8	35	2.1	21	1.3
Vavuniya	3,621	100.0	2,950	81.5	307	8.5	265	7.3	99	2.7
Mullaitivu	1,383	100.0	1,215	87.9	68	4.9	73	5.3	27	1.9
Kilinochchi	1,625	100.0	1,309	80.6	120	7.4	138	8.5	58	3.5
Batticaloa	28,259	100.0	26,980	95.5	490	1.7	745	2.6	44	0.2
Ampara	31,337	100.0	29,074	92.8	603	1.9	1,620	5.2	40	0.1
Trincomalee	11,622	100.0	10,886	93.7	301	2.6	388	3.3	47	0.4
Kurunegala	64,116	100.0	57,039	89.0	4,412	6.8	2,535	4.0	130	0.2
Puttalam	47,223	100.0	40,874	86.6	2,373	5.0	3,841	8.1	135	0.3
Anuradhapura	25,622	100.0	24,102	94.1	966	3.8	497	1.9	57	0.2
Polonnaruwa	13,216	100.0	12,558	95.0	355	2.7	281	2.1	22	0.2
Badulla	13,232	100.0	12,233	92.5	633	4.8	330	2.5	36	0.2
Moneragala	4,828	100.0	4,503	93.3	225	4.6	91	1.9	9	0.2
Ratnapura	18,696	100.0	16,927	90.5	1,175	6.3	555	3.0	39	0.2
Kegalle	27,434	100.0	24,063	87.7	1,770	6.5	1,512	5.5	89	0.3